

A BIG SPLASH Baliguali village children, Puri, from 'Bachpan'; (below) Ankush Yadav, 10, from 'Janwaar' series



PHOTOGRAPHY ▼

PRESS TH

Vicky Roy's exhibition explores childhoods and resourcefulness, from Delhi's streets to a skate park in MP

Photographer Vicky Roy has known precarity up close. As a runaway from Bengal who ended up as a ragpicker at the New Delhi Railway Station, to being rehabilitated by a local NGO that restored some semblance of normalcy in his life, Roy has looked poverty in the eye, and is now paying homage to life on the streets through 'Bachpan' at Delhi's Vadehra Art Gallery.

The exhibition features 45 black-and-white photographs from two ongoing series, Bachpan, and the previously unseen Janwaar Castle, marking the gallery's second major showcase of Roy's work. The show is born of Roy's preoccupation with the resilience, courage and joy children often show in the face of adversity. "Simplicity and observation



'GODHULI, COWS RETURNING HOME', mixed media on canvas

ART ▶

MODERNITY MEETS TRADITION

A myriad influences inform the art of **Haren Thakur** in his ongoing exhibition at Art Magnum, Delhi

A modernist whose work intricately weaves traditional tribal art forms with contemporary aesthetics, Jharkhand-based Haren Thakur's art reflects a deep engagement with nature, life and spirituality. "The relationship between man and nature forms an integral part of Haren's visual language," says show curator Dr Alka Pande.

Educated at Kala Bhavana in Santiniketan, Thakur studied under some of the most influential figures in modern Indian art. He draws significant inspiration from rural life, his visual language is deeply influenced by Munda and Birhor rock art, and he also incorporates elements of Warli art and Cubism in his works. "I believe that when some pain, any kind of churning or intense feelings, is mixed with paint,